

Mediterranean Diet Shopping List for Arthritis (UK Guide)

Practical NHS-backed advice on mediterranean diet shopping list for arthritis uk.

By **Living With Arthritis UK** · Reviewed by **Louis Maxwell** (HCPC Registered Physiotherapist) · 2026-07-24 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

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Quick Answer: A UK Mediterranean diet shopping list for arthritis should include: salmon, sardines, olive oil, colourful vegetables, leafy greens, legumes (chickpeas, lentils), wholegrain bread, walnuts, berries, and low-fat yoghurt — all widely available at UK supermarkets and forming the evidence base for an anti-inflammatory diet.

The Mediterranean diet is the most evidence-supported eating pattern for arthritis inflammation. This practical UK shopping list makes it easy to start this week using everyday supermarket staples.

Protein Section

Fish (Aim for 2–3 Times Weekly)

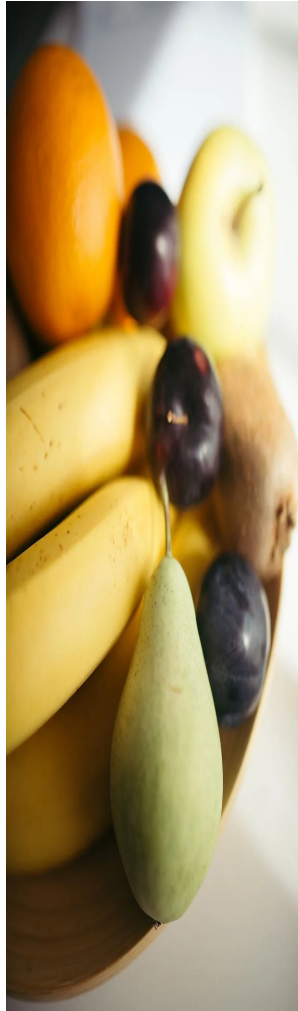
- Salmon fillets (fresh or frozen) — high in omega-3
- Tinned sardines or mackerel in olive oil — affordable omega-3 option
- Tinned tuna in spring water
- Cod, haddock, or white fish

Other Proteins

- Tinned chickpeas, lentils, kidney beans
- Eggs
- Low-fat natural or Greek yoghurt

- Small amounts of chicken or turkey
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Vegetables and Fruit



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- Spinach, kale, and leafy greens
 - Broccoli and cauliflower
 - Tinned or fresh tomatoes
 - Peppers (red, yellow, orange)
 - Sweet potato
 - Frozen berries (blueberries, strawberries)
 - Cherries or tart cherry juice
 - Citrus fruit
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Store Cupboard and Grains

- Extra virgin olive oil
 - Wholegrain bread, wholemeal pasta, brown rice, oats
 - Walnuts, almonds, mixed nuts and seeds
 - Turmeric and ginger
 - Green tea
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Q&A;



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Question: Is a Mediterranean diet expensive in the UK? **Short answer:** Not necessarily. Tinned sardines, frozen berries, and tinned chickpeas are very affordable. The biggest saving is reducing expensive meat and replacing it with cheaper fish and

legumes.

Question: Can vegetarians follow this diet for arthritis? **Short answer:** Yes — replace fish omega-3 with algae-based supplements. The plant-based elements of the Mediterranean diet are inherently vegetarian and vegan-friendly.

Question: How quickly will I notice a difference? **Short answer:** Most people notice improved energy and general wellbeing within 4–8 weeks. Measurable reduction in inflammation markers typically appears over 3–6 months of consistent dietary change.

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